

How to Connect a Data Feed (Feed Settings)

Connections & Data Feeds / Setup | beginner | 10 min to complete | DeepCharts Help Center | July 15, 2026

By the end you will have your data feed saved in Feed Settings, connected with a green dot, and a chart loading live data. This is the generic walkthrough that applies to every feed source — provider-specific guides (How to Connect a dxFeed Data Feed, How to Connect a Rithmic Data Feed, How to Connect CQG (AMP, Optimus, EdgeClear, Ironbeam...) and others) follow the same shape with their exact values filled in.

Before you start

- Your feed credentials (username and password issued for the feed — not your provider's website login). If you have no feed yet, see How to Buy a Data Feed and Get Your Credentials or start with the Use the Free 15-Minute Delayed Data Feed.
- The market data agreement signed for your account type — see Sign Your Market Data Agreement. Without it the connection stays red even with correct credentials.
- The exact **Feed Source** and **Server** values for your provider — look them up in Supported Brokers, Prop Firms and Data Feeds.

Steps

1. In DeepCharts, click **Select Connection** in the main toolbar.
2. Click **Feed Settings** at the bottom of the dropdown. The Feed Settings window opens.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] DeepCharts main toolbar with the Select Connection dropdown open and the Feed Settings entry at the bottom of the dropdown highlighted `select-connection-feed-settings.png`

3. Click **Add Connection**. A form with several fields appears.
4. In **Name**, type any name you will recognize later — for example "Apex Eval" or "My dxFeed". This is only a label; it appears in the Select Connection dropdown.
5. In **Feed Source**, pick the source that matches your account:

Your account	Feed Source
dxFeed bought from the DeepCharts website or from dxfeed.com	dxFeed
dxFeed from a prop firm (MFF, Aqua, Goat...)	dxFeed Prop
Any Rithmic account (prop firm, broker, website purchase)	Rithmic RAPI
CQG account from a broker or directly from CQG	CQG
Free built-in delayed feed	15 min delayed
DeepCharts Competition account	V-Sim
Interactive Brokers	IBKR (TWS API)

Note: The Rithmic dropdown entries are **Rithmic RAPI** and **Rithmic Wss - beta** — there is no plain "Rithmic" option. Pick **Rithmic RAPI**: it is the recommended source.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Add Connection form in Feed Settings with the Feed Source dropdown open showing the full list of sources `add-connection-feed-source.png`

6. Enter your **Username** and **Password**.

Warning: These are the credentials issued for the feed itself, usually delivered in a welcome email from your broker or prop firm. They are not the login for the provider's website or dashboard — using the website login is the single most common cause of a failed connection.

7. If a **Server** field appears, set it to the exact value for your provider from Supported Brokers, Prop Firms and Data Feeds. Rithmic prop firms each have a named entry (for example "Apex"); firms without one use "Rithmic Paper Trading"; broker Rithmic accounts use "Rithmic 01"; website-bought dxFeed uses "Website Account". When Feed Source is **dxFeed Prop** no Server field exists — that is normal.

If you picked Rithmic RAPI

- Set **Gateway** to the region closest to you. The options are Automatic, Chicago Area, Seoul, Mumbai, Hong Kong, Sao Paolo, Singapore, Sydney, Tokyo, Frankfurt, Europe, Cape Town, NYC Area and US West; the default is Automatic. A distant gateway still works but adds latency.
- **Include commissions** is on by default — it shows commissions in your P/L.
- Enable **Show only active accounts** if old or expired prop accounts clutter your account list.
- Leave the **Use R Trader** button alone unless you want to run R Trader alongside DeepCharts on the same feed — that setup is covered in Connect Rithmic Using the RTrader Pro Plugin.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Rithmic RAPI connection form filled in, with the Gateway dropdown open showing the region list and Automatic selected `rithmic-rapi-gateway-options.png`

If you picked dxFeed or dxFeed Prop

- Set **DOM Type** to **MBO** or **MBP**. MBO delivers full market-by-order Level 2 depth (best for orderflow tools); MBP is much lighter data and is the right choice if your connection is slow or charts lag during busy periods.

If you picked CQG

- Enable **Use demo credentials** only if you have a CQG demo account; leave it off for a live account.
- Enable **Connect on startup** if you want this feed to connect automatically every time DeepCharts opens.

8. Leave every other field at its default and click **Save**.

9. Back in the main toolbar, click **Select Connection** again — your new feed now appears under the name you gave it. Click it to connect. Within about 10 seconds the connection indicator should turn green.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Select Connection dropdown showing the newly saved feed with a green status dot next to it `feed-connected-green-dot.png`

10. Disconnect the feed (click it again), then set up your exchanges in **Options** → **Symbol Manage** — follow Symbol Manage: Subscribe Exchanges and Map Your Feed. This step routes each exchange to your new feed; skipping it is the biggest cause of "connected but charts not moving" tickets.

11. Reconnect the feed, then open a chart via **New** → **Price Chart** — see Open Your First Chart.

Verify it worked

- The dot next to your connection in **Select Connection** is green.
- A chart opened on a subscribed exchange draws candles and the price updates (live, or with a 15-minute lag if you chose the delayed feed).

If something went wrong

Symptom	See
Dot stays red — "check username and password"	Fix: Connection Failed — Check Username and Password
Dot stays red — "bad server"	Fix: Connection Failed — Bad Server
Dot stays red — "unable to establish connection"	Fix: Connection Failed — Unable to Establish Connection
Rithmic asks you to log in using R Trader	Fix: Please Log In Using R Trader or R Trader Pro

Symptom	See
Dot is green but the chart does not move	Fix: Live Feed Connected but Chart Is Not Moving
Charts lag behind during busy periods	Fix: Charts Lagging or Data Delayed (Checklist)

Note: If you also run DeepDom, both applications share one data bridge — a single connection serves both at the same time, but the feed settings must be entered identically in both applications. Mismatched settings in one application can stop the other from connecting.

Related articles

- Supported Brokers, Prop Firms and Data Feeds
- Sign Your Market Data Agreement
- Symbol Manage: Subscribe Exchanges and Map Your Feed
- Manage and Switch Between Feed Connections
- Open Your First Chart